

AlifUp

Workbook

Learn to read the Quran, letter by letter. The 28 letters, their shapes, the vowels and the reading rules — with tracing, reading practice and an answer key.

For learners of every age · use alongside the AlifUp app or on its own

How to use this workbook

1. **Arabic is read from right to left.**
   Every row of Arabic in this book starts on the right.

2. **One letter a day is plenty.**
   Read the letter's page, say its name and sound aloud, then trace and write it.

3. **Trace slowly.**
   Follow the grey outline from right to left, then write the letter on your own in the empty boxes.

4. **Read aloud.**
   Cover the Latin letters under the syllables and read the Arabic, then check yourself.

5. **Ask a teacher.**
   Pronunciation is best learned by listening. Hear every letter in the AlifUp app, and if you can, read to a teacher who can correct you.

6. **Practice pages have answers.**
   The answer key is at the end of the book.

Contents

The alphabet · 28 letter pages · Short vowels · Sukūn · Shadda · Tanwīn · Long vowels · Answer key · Certificate

The alphabet

28 letters, read from right to left: start at the top right.

ث Tha	ت Ta	ب Ba	ا Alif
د Dal	خ Kha	ح Ḥa	ج Jim
س Sin	ز Zay	ر Ra	ذ Dhal
ط Ṭa	ض Ḍad	ص Ṣad	ش Shin
ف Fa	غ Ghayn	ع ʿAyn	ظ Ẓa
م Mim	ل Lam	ك Kaf	ق Qaf
ي Ya	و Waw	ه Ha	ن Nun

LETTER 1 OF 28

Alif

Carries a long "aa" sound, or a hamza

ا

Its shapes — it never joins to the next letter

ـا

End

ا

Alone

Trace, from right to left

ا ا ا ا ا

Now write it yourself

Alif carries no vowel of its own: it lengthens a fatḥa (bā) or carries a hamza (ء), which then takes the vowel: أَ a, إِ i, أُ u.

LETTER 2 OF 28

Ba

"b" as in book — one dot below

ب

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ب	بـ	بـ	ب

Trace, from right to left

ب ب ب ب ب

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

بُ	بِ	بَ
bu	bi	ba

LETTER 3 OF 28

Ta

"t" as in tea — two dots above

ت

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـت	ـتـ	تـ	ت

Trace, from right to left

ت ت ت ت ت

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

تُ	تِ	تَ
tu	ti	ta

LETTER 4 OF 28

Tha

"th" as in think — three dots above

ث

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـث	ـثـ	ثـ	ث

Trace, from right to left

ث ث ث ث ث

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

ثُ	ثِ	ثَ
thu	thi	tha

LETTER 5 OF 28

Jim

"j" as in jam — one dot inside

ج

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ج	ـجـ	جـ	ج

Trace, from right to left

ج ج ج ج ج

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

جُ	جِ	جَ
ju	ji	ja

LETTER 6 OF 28

Ḥa

A breathy "h" from the middle of the throat



Its shapes in a word

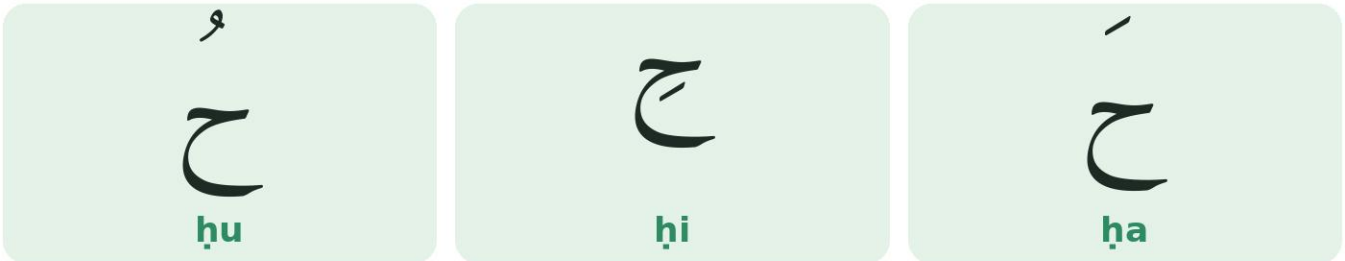
End	Middle	Start	Alone
			

Trace, from right to left



Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel



LETTER 7 OF 28

Kha

"kh" as in Scottish loch — one dot above



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
خ	خـ	ـخـ	خ

Trace, from right to left

خ خ خ خ خ

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

خُ	خِ	خَ
khu	khi	kha

LETTER 8 OF 28

Dal

"d" as in door

د

Its shapes — it never joins to the next letter

End	Alone
ـد	د

Trace, from right to left

د د د د د

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

دُ	دِ	دَ
du	di	da

LETTER 9 OF 28

Dhal

"th" as in this — one dot above

ذ

Its shapes — it never joins to the next letter

End	Alone
ـذ	ذ

Trace, from right to left

ذ ذ ذ ذ ذ

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

ذُ	ذِ	ذَ
dhu	dhi	dha

LETTER 10 OF 28

Ra

A lightly rolled "r"

ر

Its shapes — it never joins to the next letter

End	Alone
ـر	ر

Trace, from right to left

ر ر ر ر ر

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

رُ	رِ	رَ
ru	ri	ra

LETTER 11 OF 28

Zay

"z" as in zoo — one dot above

ز

Its shapes — it never joins to the next letter

End	Alone
ـز	ز

Trace, from right to left

ز ز ز ز ز

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

زُ	زِ	زَ
zu	zi	za

LETTER 12 OF 28

Sin

"s" as in sun — three teeth



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
سس	ـسـ	سـ	س

Trace, from right to left

س س س س س

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

سُ	سِ	سَ
su	si	sa

LETTER 13 OF 28

Shin

"sh" as in shoe — three dots above



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـش	ـشـ	شـ	ش

Trace, from right to left

ش ش ش ش ش

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

شُ	شِ	شَ
shu	shi	sha

LETTER 14 OF 28

Ṣad

A heavy, full-mouthed "s"

ص

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـص	ـصـ	صـ	ص

Trace, from right to left

ص ص ص ص ص

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

صُ	صِ	صَ
ṣu	ṣi	ṣa

LETTER 15 OF 28

Ḍad

A heavy "d" — Ṣad with a dot



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـض	ـضـ	ضـ	ض

Trace, from right to left

ض ض ض ض ض

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

ضُ	ضِ	ضَ
ḍu	ḍi	ḍa

LETTER 16 OF 28

Ṭa

A heavy, full-mouthed "t"



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـط	ـطـ	طـ	ط

Trace, from right to left

ط ط ط ط ط

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

طُ	طِ	طَ
ṭu	ṭi	ṭa

LETTER 17 OF 28

Ẓa

A heavy "th" as in this — Ṭa with a dot



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ظ	ظ	ظ	ظ

Trace, from right to left

ظ ظ ظ ظ ظ

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

ظُ	ظِ	ظَ
ẓu	ẓi	ẓa

LETTER 18 OF 28

ʿAyn

A deep sound squeezed from the throat



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـع	ـعـ	عـ	ع

Trace, from right to left

ع ع ع ع ع

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

عُ	عِ	عَ
ʿu	ʿi	ʿa

LETTER 19 OF 28

Ghayn

A gargled "gh", like a French r

غ

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
غ	غ	غ	غ

Trace, from right to left

غ غ غ غ غ

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

غُ	غِ	غَ
ghu	ghi	gha

LETTER 20 OF 28

Fa

"f" as in fish — one dot above



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـف	ـفـ	فـ	ف

Trace, from right to left

ف ف ف ف ف

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

فَ	فِ	فُ
fa	fi	fu

LETTER 21 OF 28

Qaf

A deep "k" from the back of the throat

ق

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ق	ـقـ	قـ	ق

Trace, from right to left

ق ق ق ق ق

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

قُ	قِ	قَ
qu	qi	qa

LETTER 22 OF 28

Kaf

"k" as in kite

ك

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ك	ـكـ	كـ	ك

Trace, from right to left

ك ك ك ك ك

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

كُ	كِ	كَ
ku	ki	ka

LETTER 23 OF 28

Lam

"l" as in lamp

ل

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـل	ـلـ	لـ	ل

Trace, from right to left

ل ل ل ل ل

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

لُ	لِ	لَ
lu	li	la

LETTER 24 OF 28

Mim

"m" as in moon



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
م	مـ	مـ	م

Trace, from right to left



Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel



mu mi ma

LETTER 25 OF 28

Nun

"n" as in noon — one dot above



Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
نن	ننـ	نـ	ن

Trace, from right to left

ن ن ن ن ن

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

نُ	نِ	نَ
nu	ni	na

LETTER 26 OF 28

Ha

A light "h" as in hat

ه

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـه	ـهـ	هـ	ه

Trace, from right to left

ه ه ه ه ه

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

هُ	هِ	هَ
ه	ه	ه
hu	hi	ha

LETTER 27 OF 28

Waw

"w" as in wall, or a long "oo"



Its shapes — it never joins to the next letter

End	Alone
و	و

Trace, from right to left

و و و و و

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

وُ	وِ	وَ
wu	wi	wa

LETTER 28 OF 28

Ya

"y" as in yes, or a long "ee"

ي

Its shapes in a word

End	Middle	Start	Alone
ـي	ـيـ	يـ	ي

Trace, from right to left

ي ي ي ي ي

Now write it yourself

Read it with each vowel

يَ	يِ	يُ
ya	yi	yu

Short vowels: Fatḥa

A small stroke above the letter: a short "a". Read every box aloud, right to left. Answers at the back.

بَ	تَ	ثَ	جَ	حَ	خَ
دَ	ذَ	رَ	زَ	سَ	شَ
صَ	ضَ	طَ	ظَ	عَ	غَ
فَ	قَ	كَ	لَ	مَ	نَ
هَ	وَ	يَ			

Short vowels: Kasra

A small stroke below the letter: a short "i". Read every box aloud, right to left. Answers at the back.

بِ	تِ	ثِ	جِ	حِ	خِ
دِ	ذِ	رِ	زِ	سِ	شِ
صِ	ضِ	طِ	ظِ	عِ	غِ
فِ	قِ	كِ	لِ	مِ	نِ
هِ	وِ	يِ			

Short vowels: Ḍamma

A small wāw above the letter: a short "u". Read every box aloud, right to left. Answers at the back.

بُ	تُ	ثُ	جُ	حُ	خُ
دُ	ذُ	رُ	زُ	سُ	شُ
صُ	ضُ	طُ	ظُ	عُ	غُ
فُ	قُ	كُ	لُ	مُ	نُ
هُ	وُ	يُ			

Sukūn — no vowel

A small circle above a letter means it has no vowel of its own. It closes the syllable before it: m-a-k is read "mak".

Examples

مِنْ	قُلْ	مَكْ
min	**qul**	**mak**

Practice: read each word aloud

1 جِفْ	2 غُجْ	3 ذُلْ
4 فِكْ	5 فُظْ	6 وُطْ
7 ذَلْ	8 ثَسْ	9 جِبْ
10 مِنْ	11 سَضْ	12 رِصْ

Shadda — a doubled letter

A small "w" above a letter means: say it twice — hold it, then add its vowel. r-a-bb-a is read "rabba".

Examples

كُلُّ	تُمَّ	رَبَّ
kullu	**tumma**	**rabba**

Practice: read each word aloud

1 سُّ بِم	2 ثُطَّ	3 فُضِّ
4 طَوِّ	5 بُفِّ	6 طِجِّ
7 قُمَّ	8 ضُ ِّ	9 صُضِّ
10 قِنُّ	11 يَهَّ	12 وَتُّ

Tanwīn — the "n" endings

A doubled vowel mark adds an "n": "an", "in", "un". It comes at the end of a word; the "an" form is usually followed by an alif, which is not read.

Examples

بًا	بٍ	بٌ
ban	**bin**	**bun**

Practice: read each word aloud

1 غُجٌ	2 كِظًا	3 ظَجً
4 نِمٍ	5 نٌ	6 صٌ
7 يغٌ	8 ظِضًا	9 زِبًا
10 حُلٍ	11 يُظٍ	12 دِهٍ

Long vowels

Alif after fatḥa, yā after kasra and wāw after ḍamma stretch the vowel to two beats: "bā", "bī", "bū".

Examples

بَا	بِي	بُو
bā	bī	bū

Practice: read each word aloud

1 وِيضْ	2 تِشِي	3 جِهُو
4 غِطَا	5 هِشُو	6 ظِيجْ
7 ضَاظْ	8 ثَظُو	9 ثُذَا
10 تُوزْ	11 لِحَا	12 قُوظْ

Answer key

Short vowels

Fatḥa — ba · ta · tha · ja · ḥa · kha · da · dha · ra · za · sa · sha · ṣa · ḍa · ṭa · ẓa · ʿa · gha · fa · qa · ka · la · ma · na · ha · wa · ya

Kasra — bi · ti · thi · ji · ḥi · khi · di · dhi · ri · zi · si · shi · ṣi · ḍi · ṭi · ẓi · ʿi · ghi · fi · qi · ki · li · mi · ni · hi · wi · yi

Ḍamma — bu · tu · thu · ju · ḥu · khu · du · dhu · ru · zu · su · shu · ṣu · ḍu · ṭu · ẓu · ʿu · ghu · fu · qu · ku · lu · mu · nu · hu · wu · yu

Sukūn — no vowel

1. jif 2. ghuj 3. dhul 4. fik 5. fuẓ 6. wuṭ 7. dhal 8. thas 9. jib 10. min 11. saḍ 12. riṣ

Shadda — a doubled letter

1. yimmu 2. thuṭṭa 3. fuḍḍi 4. ṭawwi 5. buffi 6. ṭijji 7. qumma 8. ḍuyyi 9. ṣuḍḍi 10. qinnu 11. yahha 12. wattu

Tanwīn — the "n" endings

1. ghujun 2. kiẓan 3. ẓajun 4. nimin 5. nurun 6. ṣuzun 7. yughun 8. ẓiḍan 9. ziban 10. ḥulin 11. yuẓin 12. dihin

Long vowels

1. wīḍ 2. tishī 3. jihū 4. ghiṭā 5. hithū 6. ẓīj 7. ḍāẓ 8. thaẓū 9. thudhā 10. tūz 11. liḥā 12. qūẓ

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Certificate

This certifies that

_____

has learned to read the 28 Arabic letters,

the vowels and the reading rules.

_____ _____

Date Teacher